"IN THE BEGINNING..."

GENESIS 15

IN 5 MINUTES

When:

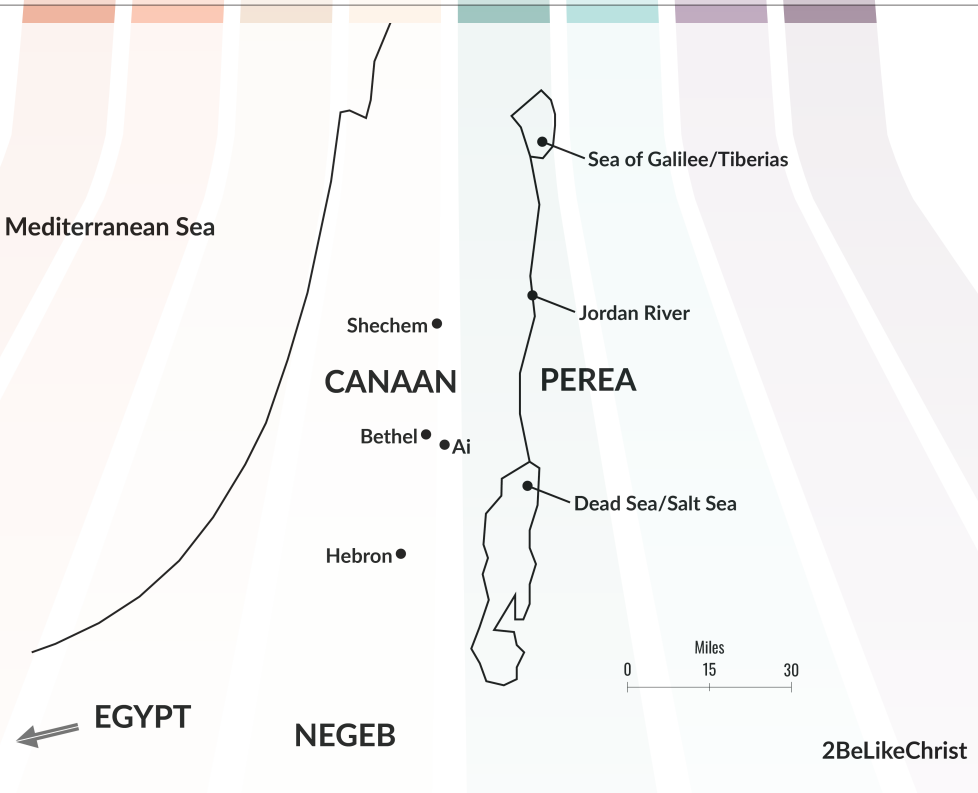
- Abram was born in approximately 1996 B.C. and died in 1821 B.C. at 175 years old (Gen 25:7).
- The events recorded in Genesis 15 happened sometime between Abram's 75th and 100th birthday, between 1921-1896 B.C.

Characters:

- **Abram** – A man from Ur of the Chaldeans who moved to Canaan at God's instruction. God promised to make his descendants a great nation and to give them the land of Canaan.

Where:

- Genesis 15 recounts how God appeared to Abram in a vision, but we aren't told where Abram was when the vision occurred.



Outline:

- GOD PROMISES ABRAM HE WILL GIVE HIM MANY CHILDREN (15:1-7):
    + After God appeared to Abram in a vision, Abram expressed his concern with God's promise to make him a great nation, because he and Sarai were unable to conceive children.
    + God told Abram not to worry because his descendants would be equal to the number of stars in the heavens.
    + Abram "believed the LORD, and He counted it to him as righteousness."
- GOD PROMISES CANAAN TO ABRAM'S DESCENDANTS (15:8-21):
    + Abram asked God how he could be sure his children would inherit the land of Canaan.
    + God told him to take a heifer, a female goat, a ram, a turtle dove, and a pigeon and cut them in half, except for the pigeon.
    + Abram did as God instructed, and that night God caused him to fall asleep and experience a "dreadful and great darkness."
    + Abraham was told his offspring would be strangers in another land that did not belong to them and there they would suffer for 400 years.
    + But after the 400 years, they would leave with "great possessions."
    + God was going to delay the inheritance of Canaan by Abram's descendants for 400+ years because the Amorites, who lived in Canaan, were not yet wicked enough for God to cast out.
    + God caused a fire pot and a flaming torch to pass through the divided animals.
    + He made a covenant with Abram to give his children the land "from the river of Egypt to the great river" (the Euphrates River).

Application:

- God's promises aren't always accomplished quickly, but they are always kept to the fullest degree.
- Walking in obedience to God requires patience.
- He is never rushed because He is eternal.
- It is important for us to learn that God's timetable is the best timetable.
- Living on His schedule is exactly the right pace for our lives.